

Laboratory 9: One-Page Website Creation & Deployment using Replit

THE MONITOR - Privacy Advocacy Website

1. Initial Prompt

Goal:

Build the structure with a "Dark Mode" base and a punchy accent color.

Prompt 1:

"Create a one-page advocacy website called 'THE MONITOR.'

Visual Style: Use a 'Dark Tech' theme. Background should be a very dark charcoal (#0a0a0a), text should be off-white (#e0e0e0), and use [Choose one: Electric Cyan #00f2ff OR Toxic Green #39ff14] as a sharp accent color for links, borders, and buttons. Use a clean sans-serif font like 'Inter' for body text and a monospace font like 'Roboto Mono' for headings.

Sections:

- 1. Navigation: A minimal top bar with 'System Status: Compromised' as a flickering text element.*
- 2. Hero: A large heading 'Privacy is an Error Code.' with a 'Scan for Leaks' button that scrolls to the next section.*
- 3. The Intruders: A 3-card layout (Bento Box style) showing how Big Tech tracks Location, Cookies, and Biometrics. Give these cards a subtle 1px border in the accent color.*
- 4. The Privacy Firewall: A section listing 5 steps to take back your data.*
- 5. Footer: A simple 'Disconnect' button and social links."*

2. Refinement Prompt #1

Goal:

Move away from a flat look by adding textures, glows, and terminal-inspired UI elements.

Prompt 2:

"Let's enhance the 'tech' feel of the site:

- 1. Grid Overlay: Add a subtle, faint gray grid pattern to the background of the entire site to make it look like a digital blueprint.*

2. *Glow Effects: Make the accent-colored borders and buttons have a subtle outer glow (box-shadow) so they look like neon tubes or LED screens.*
3. *Interactive Cards: When I hover over 'The Intruders' cards, they should slightly lift and the border color should brighten.*
4. *Data Ticker: Add a small, scrolling horizontal 'Live Data Feed' bar at the bottom of the Hero section that displays phrases like 'USER_ID: 8829... TRACKING... ENCRYPTION: FAILED...' in a small monospace font."*

3. Refinement Prompt #2

Goal:

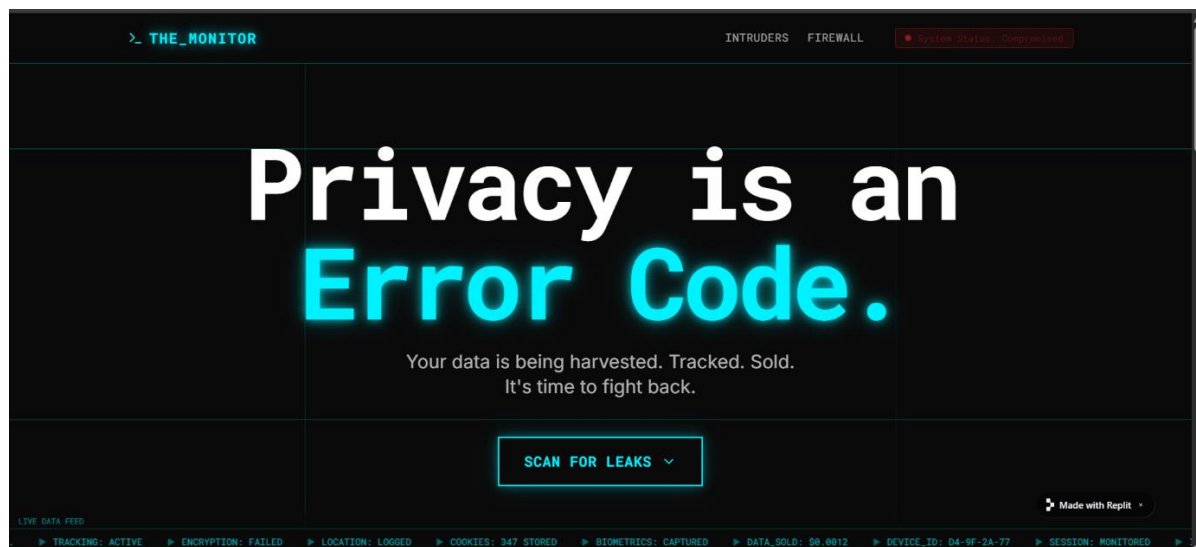
Ensure it works on mobile and add one final "advocacy" interactive element.

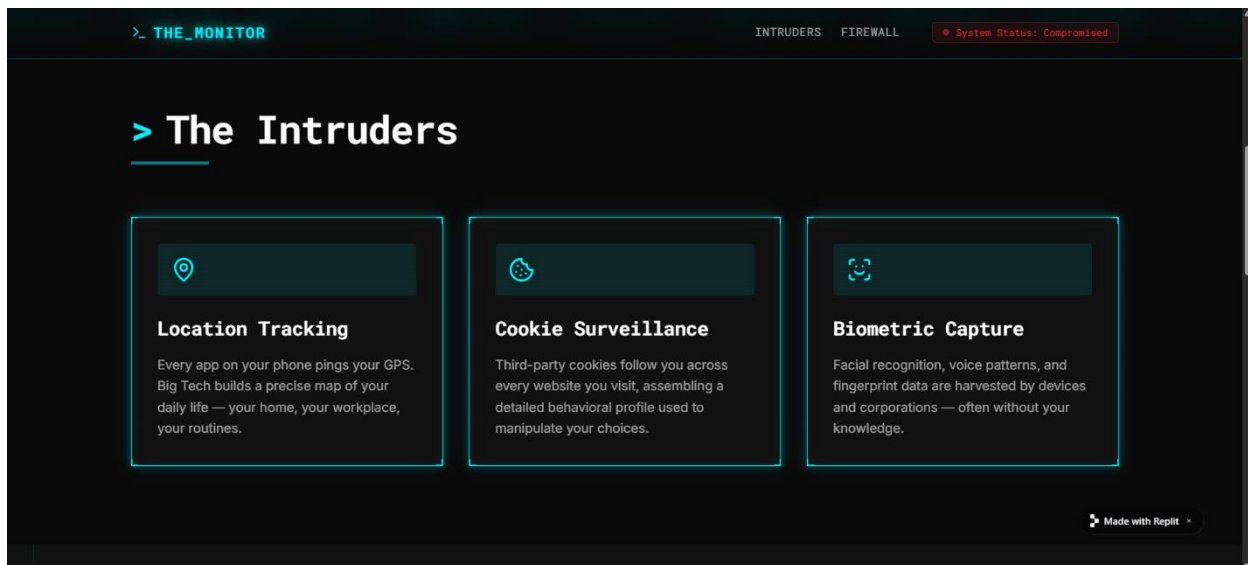
Prompt 3:

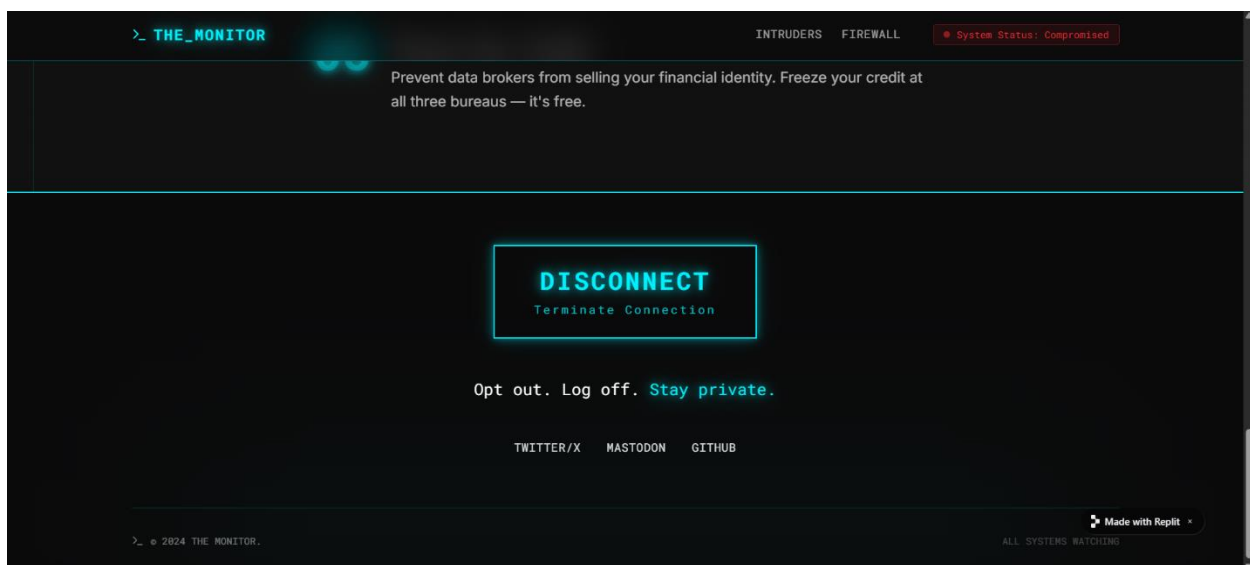
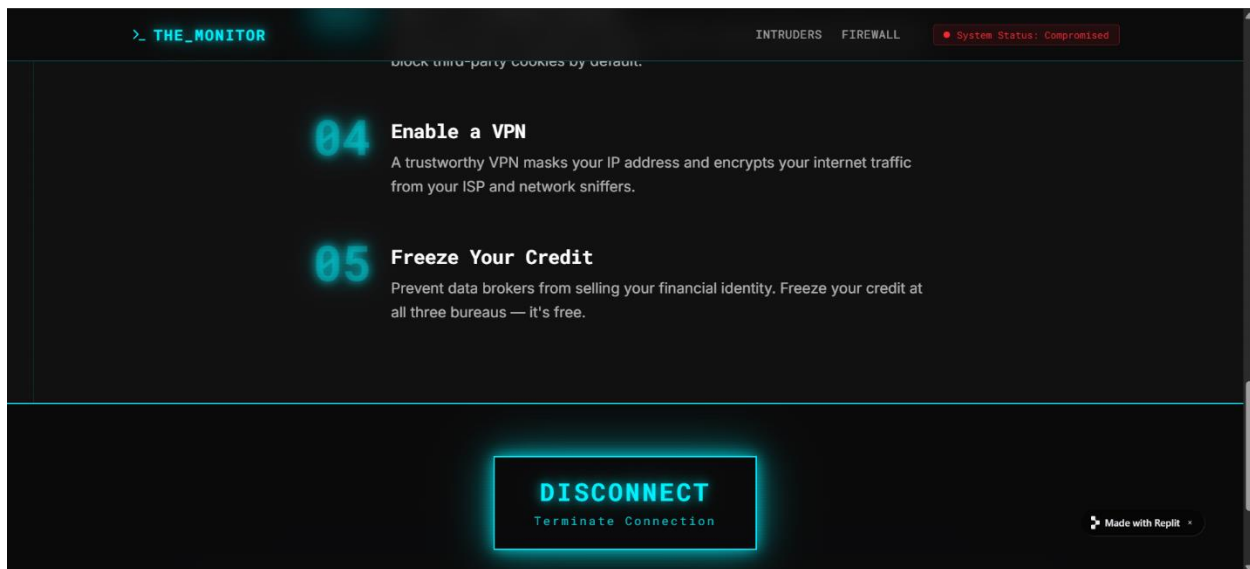
"Final refinements for 'THE MONITOR':

1. *Mobile Optimization: Ensure the site is fully responsive. On mobile, ensure the 'Bento Box' cards stack neatly and the navigation menu turns into a simple icon.*
2. *The Glitch Header: Add a subtle 'glitch' CSS animation to the main Hero headline that triggers every 5 seconds.*
3. *Call to Action: Make the 'Disconnect' button in the footer pulse slowly in the accent color.*
4. *Smooth Scroll: Ensure all navigation links have a smooth-scrolling behavior.*
5. *Glassmorphism: Make the navigation bar slightly transparent with a 'backdrop-filter: blur' effect so it looks like frosted tech-glass as you scroll."*

4. Screenshots of Outputs and Website Link







Website Link: <https://the-monitor--vidarepitome.replit.app>

5. Final Reflection

What worked well?

The structured prompting approach worked exceptionally well for this project. By breaking down the development into three distinct phases: foundation, enhancement, and polish, I was able to build complexity incrementally rather than overwhelming the AI with too many requirements at once.

The initial prompt established a strong visual identity with specific design choices (dark charcoal background #0a0a0a, electric cyan accent #00f2ff, Inter and Roboto Mono fonts) that created a cohesive "Dark Tech" aesthetic throughout the site. Replit AI

interpreted these technical specifications accurately and generated clean, semantic HTML/CSS code.

The iterative refinement prompts were particularly effective because they built upon the existing foundation. The second prompt added visual depth through grid overlays, glow effects, and the scrolling data ticker, transforming the site from a flat design into something more dynamic and engaging. The hover interactions on "The Intruders" cards added polish without requiring complex JavaScript.

The final prompt's focus on mobile responsiveness and micro-interactions (glitch animation, pulsing button, glassmorphism navigation) demonstrated how AI can handle both functional requirements and aesthetic details when given clear, specific instructions.

What needed manual fixing?

While the AI-generated code was largely functional, several adjustments were necessary to achieve the desired result:

First, the scrolling data ticker animation occasionally ran too fast or stuttered on certain browsers, requiring manual adjustment of the CSS keyframe timing and animation duration to ensure smooth, consistent scrolling across different devices.

The glitch effect on the hero headline sometimes triggered too frequently or was too subtle to notice. I had to fine-tune the animation interval (from every 5 seconds to every 7 seconds) and increase the distortion slightly to make it more noticeable while still maintaining subtlety.

The mobile breakpoints needed adjustment, the initial responsive design stacked the cards too early (at 900px width instead of 768px), creating awkward spacing on tablet devices. Manual media query refinement was necessary to ensure the layout adapted properly across all screen sizes.

What did you learn about prompting?

Through this project, I learned that successful AI prompting is a blend of extreme precision and strategic layering. I discovered that specificity is vital; using exact hex codes and industry terms like "glassmorphism" or "Bento Box layout" yields professional results that vague instructions simply cannot match. Instead of using one massive prompt, I found that iterative layering, moving from a foundation to enhancement and then to final polish, prevented the AI from becoming overwhelmed and made debugging much simpler. By maintaining contextual continuity and using technical vocabulary, I ensured the design remained consistent across every update. This experience proved that while AI is a powerful collaborator for code generation, human direction and critical evaluation are what transform a generic output into a refined, purposeful advocacy tool.